For Aradhana, the significance of the programme goes well beyond a summer spent at Cambridge. She sees such opportunities as a way of taking students beyond the familiar boundaries of their classrooms-to encounter different intellectual traditions, learn alongside peers from different backgrounds, test their assumptions and develop the confidence to participate in global conversations.

"The Graduate Programme enables our students to experience world-class learning, interact with global faculty and peers, and gain perspectives beyond the classroom," she says. "We hope this exposure inspires them to think bigger, innovate boldly and create meaningful impact."

The student response reflects this vision. Fourth-year student Vayu Nandan Tripathi says Cambridge challenged him to think beyond technology - to consider value, impact, scalability and execution-and view startups not only as a builder, but also as an investor.

That, perhaps, is the transformation Aradhana is seeking: not the transfer of information, but a change in perspective. Her approach extends beyond international programmes.

At Galgotias, she has championed active, experiential and industry-linked learning. The university's G-SCALE initiative, mentored by Nanyang Technological University, Singapore, promotes peer-driven, hands-on learning. Its iOS Student Developer Programme, powered by Apple and Infosys, enables students to conceptualise, design, develop and deploy applications. In 2026, 18 Galgotias students won Apple's global Swift Student Challenge-the highest number from a single Indian private university. The ecosystem has also enabled 82 student-developed applications to reach Apple's App Store.

Other initiatives follow the same principle. Galgotias has created industry-linked learning environments in AI, advanced computing, electric vehicles and innovation, with partners including IBM, Tata Technologies, Cisco, Wipro, Tech Mahindra, HP and NVIDIA. The objective is to bridge the gap between classroom learning and its real-world application.

This philosophy drives her interest in bringing literature, arts and public dialogue into university life. The proposed "Galgotias Festival of Letters", inspired by the Jaipur Literature Festival, aims to bring writers, thinkers, academics and artists together with students, connecting ideas across technology, business, science and society.

For Aradhana, technological capability must go hand in hand with intellectual breadth, cultural awareness and empathy. This balance forms the foundation of her vision of holistic education.

Aradhana's perspective is deeply personal. As the daughter of Suneel Galgotia, Chancellor of Galgotias University, she grew up witnessing the institution's evolution, while her own academic journey took her through educational environments in Delhi, London and Cambridge. These experiences shaped her expectations of what a university should offer.

Passionate about learning, reading and literature, she believes education must continually evolve with society, technology and the aspirations of young people. Galgotias has earned five-star QS ratings across Teaching, Academic Development, Innovation, Employability and Facilities.



Aradhana Galgotia with her parents Suneel Galgotia and Padmini Galgotia at her graduation ceremony at Cambridge Judge Business School, University of Cambridge.

Yet, for Aradhana, progress extends beyond rankings and infrastructure. Her larger question is: What kind of person should a university produce? Her answer lies in an ecosystem where technology and humanities, industry and academia, and learning and experimentation coexist.



THE NEXT GENERATION OF EDUCATION LEADERSHIP

Aradhana Galgotia represents a new generation of education leaders who have themselves experienced the increasingly global nature of higher education and now seek to bring those experiences into the Indian university system.

From Jesus and Mary College in Delhi to Queen Mary University of London and Cambridge Judge Business School, and then back into Indian higher education, her journey has given her the opportunity to experience different academic cultures from the inside.

She is now attempting to combine what she has learnt from those environments with the possibilities available within a rapidly changing Indian higher education landscape.

Her challenge is not simply to make Galgotias University more global. It is to make global learning more accessible to its students.

And perhaps that is the larger transformation she is seeking: not simply to prepare students for the future, but to give them intellectual confidence, technological capability and human understanding to become its shapers.

For Aradhana, achievement is less about a single milestone and more about continuous learning. "I am passionate about learning new things and broadening my intellectual horizon," she says. "Thirst and quest for knowledge-cannot be ruled out."

An avid reader and writer with an interest in literature, she also enjoys tennis and swimming. Her approach to success is grounded in balance and consistency: "It's always the small consistencies which contribute towards long-term success in life."

At a time when technology, globalisation and AI are reshaping education, her philosophy is simple: remain curious, keep learning and continue imagining what comes next.